

EUROPEAN PARLIAMENT

EURO BARO METER

KEY FINDINGS

SOCIAL MEDIA SURVEY 2025



European
Parliament

KEY FINDINGS

Information habits and sources

Just over four in ten (42%) respondents report that they '**frequently**' discuss social and political current affairs when getting together with friends or relatives, and about half (51%) mention doing so '**occasionally**'. Fewer than one in ten (6%) respondents indicate that they '**never**' do so.

Two-thirds (66%) of respondents use **traditional media (offline or digital services of TV stations, newspapers, radio stations, etc.)** to follow content on social and political current affairs on a daily basis. About six in ten (59%) respondents use **other digital sources (such as social media, video – or streaming platforms, blogs, online news portals, etc.)** to follow content on social and political current affairs on a daily basis.

Asked about information sources used for getting information on social and political current affairs, about seven in ten (71%) indicate using the **TV**. More than four in ten (43%) mention the **radio**, closely followed by **printed newspapers and magazines or their online versions** (41%), **search engines** (e.g. Google Search or Bing) (40%), **social media platforms** (e.g. Instagram, TikTok, Facebook, X, etc.) (40%) and **friends, family and colleagues** (40%).

Just over four in ten respondents (42%) answer that **TV** has become more important for them over the last year. One in five (25%) point to **social media platforms (e.g. Instagram, TikTok, Facebook, X, etc.)**, and fewer than one in four report increased importance, over the last year, of **printed newspapers and magazines or their online versions** (19%), the **radio** (18%) and **search engines (e.g. Google Search or Bing)** (18%).

Respondents were asked about a range of **topics on social and political current affairs that they generally follow or pay attention to**. About six in ten (61%) mention **public health and healthcare systems**. Over four in ten indicate generally following or paying attention to **democracy and the rule of law** (47%), **migration and asylum** (45%) or **action against climate change** (43%). Four in ten respondents (40%) report following or paying attention to **the EU's defence and security**, the same share mention (40%) **poverty reduction and social inclusion**. More than one-third of respondents point to **support to the economy and the creation of jobs** (37%), as well as **foreign policy and trade** (36%), as topics of interest in social and political current affairs. Smaller shares answer they are following or paying attention to **agriculture and food security** (28%) and **the EU's autonomy in the fields of industry and energy** (19%).

Social media use

Users of social media and platforms for current affairs information were asked to identify the platforms they use the most for this purpose. Over one in two users indicate **Facebook** (58%) and **YouTube** (57%) as the most important ones, followed by **Instagram** (46%). Fewer than one-third of users mention **TikTok** (31%), **WhatsApp** (27%) and **X (Twitter)** (25%), and at least one in ten point to **Telegram** (13%) and **LinkedIn** (10%) as important platforms.

The survey findings reveal a combination of active and passive consumption of social and political information on social media, with many users both intentionally seeking out content and unexpectedly encountering it during casual browsing. Just over three-quarters (76%) of respondents agree with the statement '**When browsing social media, I sometimes read social and political information that I have come across by chance, even though I was not actively searching for it**'. On the other hand, two-thirds (66%) of social media and platforms users agree with the statement '**I actively search for information about social and political current affairs on social media**'.

Respondents in the survey were asked in which ways, if any, they engaged with social and political content on social media. Over one-third of respondents report that they **read or view content on their feed(s)** (38%) or that they **like or react to posts** (36%). Fewer than one in four (23%) respondents **comment on posts**, and fewer than one in five **share others' posts on their profile or stories** (19%) or **share content through direct messages or private chats** (18%). About one in ten (11%) **create and post their own original content (e.g. thoughts/opinions on issues)**.

Exposure and response to disinformation and trust in messengers

Asked **how often they think they have personally been exposed to disinformation and fake news over the past seven days**, over one-third of respondents indicate they have been exposed '**very often**' (12%) or '**often**' (23%). Three in ten respondents (31%) report they have '**sometimes**' been exposed to disinformation and fake news over the past week, and fewer than one in four report they have '**rarely**' (16%) or '**never**' (7%) been exposed.

Just over six in ten respondents feel confident that they can **recognise disinformation when they encounter it** (12% '**very confident**', 49% '**somewhat confident**'). About three in ten are, on the other hand, not confident in their ability to recognise disinformation (of which 26% '**not very confident**' and 6% '**not at all confident**').

Respondents were then asked what they typically do, when they are unsure whether a piece of information on social media is disinformation. About one in two (49%) respondents mention **cross-checking it with other sources of information to see if they are saying the same thing**.

Four in ten (40%) respondents indicate that they **look at who posted it to check if it's from a trusted or distrusted source**. About one-third (34%) of respondents report that they **check if it's recent news, not an old story being shared again**, and fewer than three in ten answer that they **check the comments to see what other people are saying about it** (29%), **check if the pictures or videos look real or fake** (25%), or **look out for spelling or grammar mistakes** (24%). Fewer than two in ten respondents mention that, in order to verify whether a piece of information on social media is disinformation, they either **ask people they trust what they think** (18%) or **use a fact-checking tool or website** (14%). Notably, one in ten (10%) respondents indicate that they **do not do anything to verify the information**.

Following influencers and content creators

More than one-third of respondents (37%) indicate that **they follow influencers or content creators** on social media channels (e.g. YouTube, Instagram, or TikTok, etc.).

Respondents who report following influencers or content creators on social media were then asked about their **preferred content types from these accounts**. About four in ten followers mention **reviews (e.g. products, books, places, etc.)** (39%), **commentary on social and political current affairs** (38%) and **how to's (e.g. tutorials)** (38%). These are followed by **insight into their everyday life** (36%) and **motivational content** (31%). A smaller proportion of followers, close to one in five (19%), indicate a preference for the **promotion and advertising of commercial products**.

Preferred formats for political content on social media

Just over two in ten (22%) respondents indicate that they **follow what's going on in EU politics 'most of the time'**, and more than four in ten (44%) respondents report doing so **'from time to time'**. Another one-fifth (21%) of respondents mention **'rarely'** following what's going on in EU politics. About one in ten (11%) reply that they **'never or almost never'** do so.

Respondents who indicate using social media and/or platforms for information on social and political current affairs were then asked about their preferred formats for such information on social media. More than four in ten users report a preference for **short text-based posts (e.g. images with short text, status updates)** (46%) and for **short videos (e.g. TikTok, Instagram Reels, under 1 minute)** (39%). This is followed by a preference for **medium-length videos (e.g. 1-5 minutes)** (39%) and **longer videos (e.g. YouTube, over 5 minutes)** (35%), each selected by over one-third of users. About one in four users, on the other hand, express a preference for **stories (e.g. Instagram Stories)** (26%), **longer text-based articles (e.g. articles, blog posts)** (25%), **live streams or live videos** (24%) and **podcasts** (24%). Smaller shares mention

infographics or charts (animated or not) (19%) and **newsletters (e.g. LinkedIn newsletters, Substack)** (15%).

Respondents using social media and/or platforms for information on social and political current affairs were then also asked to express their video content preferences in relation to current affairs information on social media. More than four in ten users report a preference for **videos exploring current affairs in depth** (47%), **interviews with experts (e.g. academics or political analysts)** (44%) and **interviews with everyday people or citizens affected by the issue** (42%). Just over one-third of users point to **interviews with politicians or government officials** (34%), and three in ten (30%) users indicate **videos combining people on camera with graphics, text, or animations** as preferred types of video content about current affairs.

Attitudes towards the EU

Respondents were asked to rate the importance of their country being a Member State of the EU on a scale from 1 to 10, where 1 means 'not at all important' and 10 means 'extremely important'. Overall, across the EU, about two-thirds (66%) of respondents **consider their country's membership to be important (scores 8-10)** and 15% view it as of **low importance (scores 1-4)**. Fewer than two in ten respondents (16%) select a more moderate stance on the scale (scores 5-6 'Neither important, nor unimportant').

Over six in ten respondents are generally in favour of the EU: 27% are **in favour of the EU and the way it is working at present**; 37% are rather **in favour of the EU, but not the way it is working at present**. About one-fifth (21%) of respondents are **rather sceptical of the EU, but could change their opinion if the way it works really changes**. Fewer than one in ten (8%) respondents are **opposed to the idea of the EU in general**.

When asked about their trust in various entities, over four in ten respondents indicate that they trust the most **friends and family** (45%) and **scientists** (45%). Between one in five and one in ten respondents report trusting the most **school teachers or university lecturers** (17%), **journalists** (13%), **public institutions** (13%), **NGOs** (11%) and **media** (10%). Smaller shares trust the most any other entity: **private companies** (6%), **politicians** (5%), **influencers or content creators** (4%) or **other** (3%). Notably, one in ten (10%) respondents report that they trust **none of these** listed entities the most.

This Flash Eurobarometer provides an overview of European citizens' attitudes towards social media. It examines attitudes towards key themes, such as: information habits and sources for social and political current affairs; social media usage patterns and preferences for information on current affairs; exposure and response to disinformation and trust in messengers; engagement with influencers and content creators on social media; audience and preferences for institutional accounts and political content on social media; preferred formats and content types for political content on social media; attitudes towards the European Union.

On behalf of the European Parliament's Directorate-General for Communication, Ipsos European Public Affairs interviewed a representative sample of EU citizens, aged 15 and over, in each of the 27 Member States of the European Union (EU). Between 11 and 18 June 2025, 26 121 interviews were conducted via computer-assisted web interviewing (CAWI), using Ipsos' online panels and their partner network.



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